FUNDAMENTALS OF A DIET

Food's 3 musketeers: fats, carbs & protein

FATS



The most efficient source of energy, with each gram of fat containing 9 calories, compared to 4 each for carbs and proteins

Which foods provide fats?
Fats are of four kinds.

Saturated fats: Found in beef, pork, poultry, full-fat dairy items, eggs, and in coconut and palm oils

Transfats: Naturally-occurring transfats are produced in the gut of some animals. Artificial ones are made in an industrial process

Monoun-saturated fats: Found in olive, canola, peanut and sunflower oils, avocados and peanut butter

Polyunsaturated fats: Found in fatty fish, walnuts, flaxseeds, tofu, soybean. Rich source of Omega 3 and 6

Recommended amount: 25-30% calories must come from unsaturated fats, 5-6% from saturated. Transfats should be avoided entirely

CARBOHYDRATES



They are what power the body, breaking down into simple sugars once ingested. Once the level of sugar rises in the blood, the pancreas secretes a hormone, insulin, which moves the sugar to the cells for storage

What foods are carbs found in?
Carbs are of two kinds. Simple carbs can be naturally found in fruit and milk, or they are added as refined sugar. And complex carbs? Think whole grains like brown rice, pasta, millets, some legumes

Recommended amount: Carbs must make up 45-65% of one's total calorie intake

PROTEINS



Proteins are essential for the structure, function and regulation of the body

Where can they be found?
Animal meat, seafood, eggs and milk products are considered complete proteins. Legumes and lentils provide proteins but not some amino acids, and are thus called second-class proteins

Recommended amount: Minimum 0.8 gm per kg of body weight per day



Whole Grain Rice Thali



RECOMMENDED BY

Sagar Bajaj, *Culinary head, First Fiddle Restaurants*

1. Brown rice papadum basket
2. Capsicum and coconut chutney
3. Sweet idli and mango-cardamom shrikhand
4. Tomato stuffed with cabbage and rice with green chilli onion and mustard stew
5. Brown rice and cheese paniyaram, spicy coconut chutney
6. Curd and brown rice soup with ghee-tempered mustard